



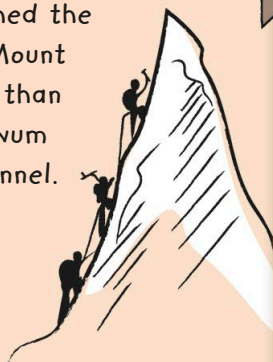
Swimming across the Channel

The Channel is a 21-mile (36km) wide **stretch of sea** between Britain and France. In 1875, **Matthew Webb** became the first person to successfully swim across it.



On August 24, 1875, Englishman Matthew Webb dived into the sea in Dover, England.

More people have reached the top of Mount Everest than have swum the Channel.



In 1926, American **Gertrude Ederle** became the first woman to complete the swim.